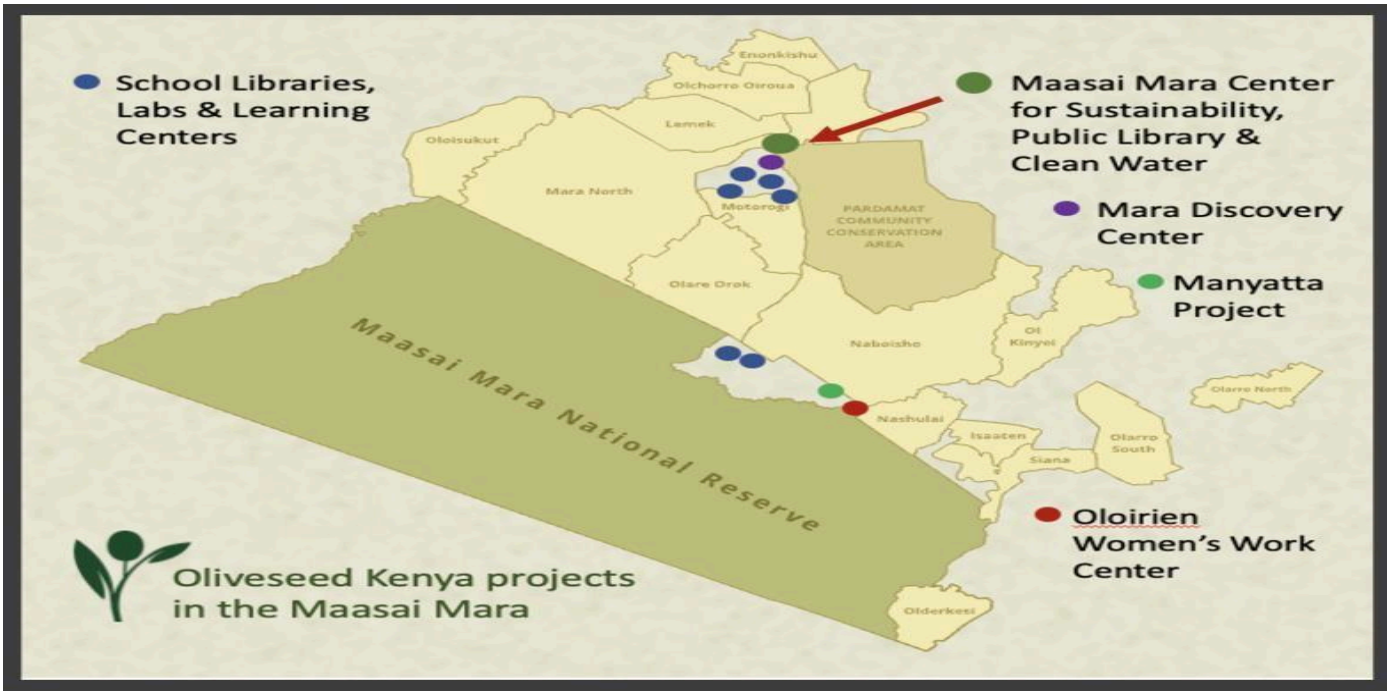
COMMUNITY NEEDS ASSESSMENT REPORT. ESTABLISHMENT OF SCHOOL LIBRARIES, COMMUNITY PUBLIC LIBRARY, COMMUNITY EDUCATION & ECO-TOURISM CENTRE.

Oliveseed Kenya.



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April 2023.

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My thanks to those who participated in a survey, questionnaires, interviews, community forum or focus group as part of this Public Library, Community Education and Eco-tourism center Needs Assessment. This would have been a lot less interesting without you (not to mention completely impossible)! I am honored to have been 'invited in' to assist with this assessment and to facilitate conversations and discussions about the establishment of these facilities in the community. The voices and viewpoints represented by the findings in this report are diverse. One common thread, however, is the community's commitment to the amazing projects Oliveseed Kenya Trust is looking forward to further establish in the community. My hat is off to all of you. The findings in this report are offered in the spirit of appreciation and support for building on the assets that already exists within the school libraries and other community assets, as evidenced by the praise (frequently unsolicited) offered by the key stakeholders and all the respondents throughout this process:

- "Everyone is cheerful and welcoming making the school libraries a wonderful asset to the community and a stellar example to which other workplaces should aspire to emulate."
- "Oliveseed Kenya Trust's Libraries is a tremendous asset to our community. I've used it all since and I have always been impressed by the collection and the helpfulness of the staff and the librarian. Keep up the good work on both adding to the collection and retaining older materials that are still relevant. Our library truly is a gem!
- "The Mara Sustainability Centre will truly be a change maker as we will build on the rich and abundant resources available in our land to further enrich our cultural dimensions and improved on the community education status and the eco-tourism center will be an amazing initiative''

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Oliveseed is an organization that focuses on transformation through the power of education and a respect for nature and community. The organization envision a world of knowledgeable, ethical, caring citizens living in balance with a healthy ecosystem. The development of the Mara Sustainability Centre and its programming is the manifestation of these ideals into a physical development in the heart of the community.

The Oliveseed Kenya Trust together with Oliveseed Foundation in the US contracted a consultant to perform a community needs assessment in order to gain a deeper understanding of the community it serves, including opinions and behaviors towards school library services and establishment of a public library and the community education and eco-tourism center.

GOALS AND OBJECTIVES OF THE NEEDS ASSESSMENT.

The objectives of this assessment are multidimensional and interdisciplinary by character. The assessment aims at finding the possibilities and pitfalls of community-based education and ecotourism center and community public library in Maasai Mara.

The main research problems are: *What kind of potential for community-based ecotourism exists in the Maasai Mara and in the area´ s adjacent communities and the establishment of school and community public libraries? Could ecotourism help to prevent the degradation of the indigenous cultures and forests?*

The sub-objectives are:

1) *To find out the perceptions and opinions of local people about ecotourism, community public libraries.*
2) *To study the interdependency of the local ecosystem and community viability.*
3) *To study locals´ capacity and level of empowerment in managing the natural resources and economic viability of the area (Taking into accounts; Youths & Women).*
4) *To study what kind of ecotourism would be suitable for the area.*
5) *To find out the viability of the already established libraries in selected schools and manyatta and the literacy levels in Maasai Mara.*

The problems are based on the following hypothesis: *There is no tourism in the Maasai Mara generating direct income for the local economy and the sparsely populated density and lack of a community public library in the region and the need to;*

- *Create a technical & vocational skill training center*
- *Libraries are important and essential for the community as this promotes literacy and educational level.*
- *Conservation knowledge sharing and tourism exhibitions*
- *Women empowerment*
- *Sustainable income generations'*
- *Environment conservation*
- *Alternative employment opportunities as well as for sustainable ways of economic empowerment and natural resource management.*

The assessment aims at finding answers to the research problems from the grass root level actors like the primary schools in the region, Maasai manyatta (Traditional Village), Kenya Library Services; Narok branch, National Museum of Kenya; Narok branch, women groups (Oloirien & Olkimitare Women group), community village elders, lodge & conservancies managers, conservancies associations and the religious institutions. The physical, socio-cultural and socio-ecologic features of the area form the base for the ecotourism potential.

The intended outcome was a set of findings that would support the development of programs, services and facilities based upon community needs.

The consultant, Alex Lekishon, completed the public library and community education and eco-tourism center community needs assessment with the local schools and tourism stakeholders in the Mara. The process included the following elements:

1) Project planning to establish a timeline and identify key stakeholders to engage in the assessment process;

2) Developing questions to guide the assessment;

3) Developing a reliable questionnaire to be made available through emails and via hard copy in high-traffic public locations like markets and the schools and lodges in the Mara;

4) Creating focus group and community meeting protocols to guide the assessment;

5) Facilitating three (3) focus groups with key stakeholders;

6) Facilitating two (2) community forums;

7) Compiling and analyzing data gathered through questionnaire (including data entry from questionnaires completed using a hard copy), focus group, interviews and community meetings;

8) and providing this final report to Oliveseed Kenya Trust and Oliveseed Foundation in the US.

Key findings of the assessment included the following:

- ***The staff or technician of the Library is highly regarded*** for their dedicated service (when asked what makes it easier to get what you need at the Library almost 70% of respondents indicated that staff or teachers' assistance makes it easier; the quality of staff was also mentioned in every focus group and community forum).
- ***The services currently offered by the Library are valued by the community.*** Almost 200 people participated in the Public Library Needs Survey and all library services were rated as "Very Important" or "Important" by a majority of respondents who rated services. The services that received the highest percentage of combined "Very Important" or "Important" ratings were Books (95.4%), Staff Assistance (86.7%). The services receiving the lowest percentage of combined "Very Important" and "Important" ratings were Business/entrepreneurship Information (50.4%), Online Tutoring (50%), access to Wi-Fi (45%) and Expert Research and Career.
- ***The Library's success has created some 'growing pains.'*** Demand for Library services from diverse groups (including children, teens and seniors) has resulted in calls for more seating, more quiet study areas for individuals and groups of all sizes, and more accessible programs (131 out of 363 respondents said the Library was 'too crowded' when asked what makes it hard to get what you need at the Library).
- ***There is strong demand for programs and materials in the local dialect*** (145 survey respondents out or 594 indicated that they would be more likely to attend a program if it were offered in the Maasai language or any other dialect; 100 out of 586 said they would prefer to read materials in a Maasai language).
- In imagining the 'ideal future for the Library' the most commonly mentioned elements

cited by participants in focus groups, interviews and community meetings were:

- ***Collaboration with schools, cultural groups and other key stakeholders*** was a theme that was common to all three gatherings.
- An environment ***welcoming of all cultures***. (All gatherings)
- ***Bigger space and/or reconfiguration of space*** to accommodate the needs of multiple user groups. (All gatherings)

- ***The most common recommended improvements*** to the existing Library were:
  - ***Expansion of the collection*** (books, DVDs, audio books and e-books) and ***programs*** (especially those for children and course books);
  - ***Enhanced technology*** (including hardware and software upgrades);
  - ***Improved Library PR***/external communications; Capacity building and incentives.
  - ***Increase accessibility*** through signage, a directory, and an orientation; and
  - ***Reconfiguration of the facility*** to meet the changing needs of diverse users.
- When asked about ***potential upgrades to the Public Computer Room***, 63.7% of respondents rated a ***Group Study Area*** with large screen or projector as Very Important or Important; 61.4% rated "***Laptops for Use in the Library"*** as Very Important or Important.
- ***69.1% of respondents indicated that "Staff Assistance" makes it easier*** to use the Library; 66.7% said a "Welcoming Environment" and 61.2% said "Materials, Plentiful and Easy to Find" make it easier.
- In answer to the question of what makes it hard to get services from the Library, ***41% indicated "No Place to Sit;"*** 36.1% said "Too Crowded;" and 30.6% indicated "Lack of Materials that Interest You."
- ***Maasai Mara residents are more likely to prefer programs in a language other than English.*** 35% of local residents responding to the survey indicated they would prefer programs in a language other than English versus 26.9% of respondents from outside the school's environment.
- ***Respondents (between the ages of 12 and 18) indicated that they value "Access to computers" and "Access to Wi-Fi"***; they are more frequent users of the Public Computer Room; and they have a stronger preference for Public Computer Room technology

upgrades.

- ***Frequent users of the library who responded to the survey (those who said they have visited the Library 13 or more times in the past year) value "Individual Seating," "Staff Assistance" and "Self-Service Options"*** more than in frequent users (those who indicated they used the Library 1-12 times in the past year).
- ***Based on the findings it can be noted that the tourism industry cannot sustain itself without the help of community and local government units***, which were mentioned in the interpretations of sustainable tourism by many local citizens and conservancy or lodge managers. Hence, ensuring the sustainability of tourism development implies keeping high level of awareness and strong commitment among stakeholders regarding crucial issues like quality assurance and sustainable practices like establishment of eco-tourism ventures. This indicate that there is a need to elevate the local community's participation and the local leadership and management in order to boost tourism and protect ecotourism in the local setting.
- ***According to assessment, the term "community-based ecotourism ventures" should be used to distinguish those initiatives that are environmentally*** conscious while also aiming to ensure that local residents have a high degree of control over the activities that take place and receive a significant portion of the benefits.

- **Ecotourism proponents argue that it benefits the local community by including them into the experience.** While this is true, previous studies have shown there will be differences in how the tourist industry affects people based on their gender, class, or other traits. Ethical tourism has no reason to vary in this regard. Ecology-oriented marketing materials frequently use homogeneous language when talking about "the local people" and "the local community." Conservationists, rather than developers, have a strong effect on local ecotourism efforts, which may account for some of this.
- ***Ecotourism is tourism that meets the needs of the present generation*** without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their needs from the same resources
- ***Unless the requirements of safeguarding the environment are met***, ecotourism is in

danger of being a self- destructive process, destroying the very resources upon which it is based

- ***The interdependence of tourism and the social and physical environment*** is fundamental for the future of each.
- ***Community- based natural resource management is being increasingly promoted*** as the way to tackle the environmental problems and to emphasize community empowerment in the Maasai Mara Ecosystem.

METHODOLOGIES

Project Component
Task One: Project planning with Oliveseed Kenya Trust & Oliveseed US. Together with the senior management team of Oliveseed Kenya Trust, the consultant developed a timeline for the project and a plan for engaging key education staffs, key library stakeholders, conservancy & lodge managers and the community. Following the steps outlined below, the team sought to communicate the purpose and potential benefits of the assessment as they engaged key stakeholders and community members in identifying needs.
Task Two: Development of a valid and reliable questionnaire. The consultant worked with the directors of Oliveseed Kenya Trust & Oliveseed Foundation to develop and refine a set of questions that reflect specific areas of need we hoped to assess (including demand for materials and programs currently offered; possible expansion of technology services; and areas of needed development or improvement, establishment of a community education and ecotourism center). The consultant assisted the team in developing a questionnaire, providing a draft for review and beta testing with a small number of library users and other key stakeholders prior to broad public distribution.

Task Three: Assessment of needs and recommendations through a sample of Maasai Mara residents using the questionnaire. 1) Placing paper copies of the questionnaire in the library and classrooms facilities near questionnaire collection boxes; 2) asking library program participants to complete a hard copy of the questionnaire; 3) distributing hard copies of the questionnaire to community members and distribution of paper copies of the questionnaire at meetings and gatherings outside of the Library. Survey respondents were diverse in age, frequency of Library use and residence.

Task Four: Data Analysis – Questionnaire. The consultant completed a quantitative & qualitative analysis of the data gathered through the questionnaire and provided the report on results.

Task Five: Develop Protocols (with guiding questions) for focus groups and community forums. The consultant developed protocols for gathering stakeholder feedback in group settings with an introduction, guiding questions and prompts. The key purpose of the focus groups was to have a meaningful ("deeper dive") dialog with key stakeholders about the future of library services, community education and eco-tourism Centre. The purpose of the community forums was to obtain feedback from a broader range of community residents, including those who are not currently library users, about the future of library services and also on their experience with community education and eco-tourism activities.

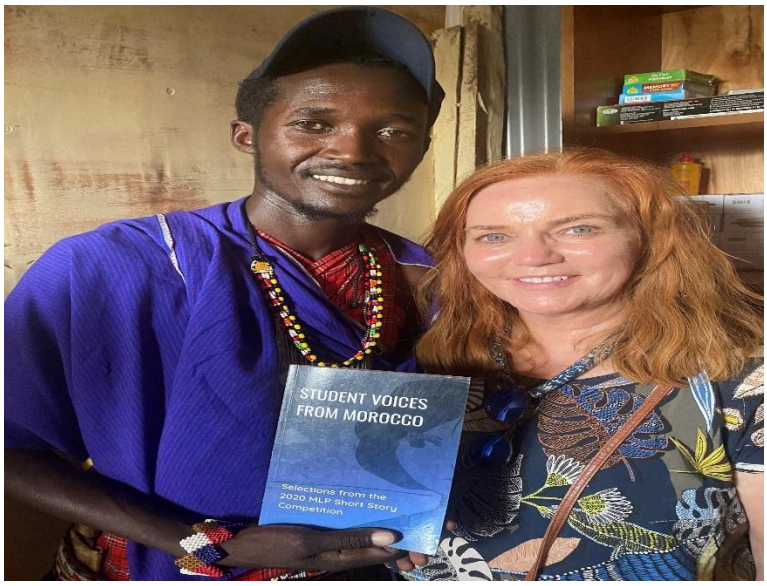
METHODOLOGIES (continued)

Task Six: Focus Group and Community Meeting Facilitation. The consultant conducted focus groups meetings with library stakeholders and lodge & conservancy managers, Library staff members, community leaders (including representatives from Narok West sub-county education, Narok country library and Narok museum representatives and the consultant also conducted community forums open to local residents and community members .

Task Seven: Data Analysis – Questionnaire, Focus Groups and Community Meetings. Data analysis focused on the recommendations of community members that emerged from the questionnaire, focus groups and community meetings. The consultant organized the qualitative data by key theme in three broad areas of focus: 1) current operations and strengths of the Library; 2) the ideal future of the library; and 3) recommended improvements or enhancements to the Library in order to meet community needs, 4) literacy levels of education in Narok county (Maasai Mara), 5) community-based ecotourism, 6) cultural tourism, 7) community viability & cultural sustainability in the Mara.
Task Eight: Development of Community Needs Assessment Report. The consultant developed this report as a tool for further use and presentation to key stakeholders of the findings of the community needs assessment .

PUBLIC LIBRARIES IN THE COMMUNITY.

Oliveseed and Rotary are working together to establish the first Public Library & Community Education Center in this region (hereafter called “Library”), for all ages and levels. The community has donated 10 acres of prime land to Oliveseed Kenya Trust for this project and related community assets, along the main road outside the town of Aitong in easy reach of 10,000 people.



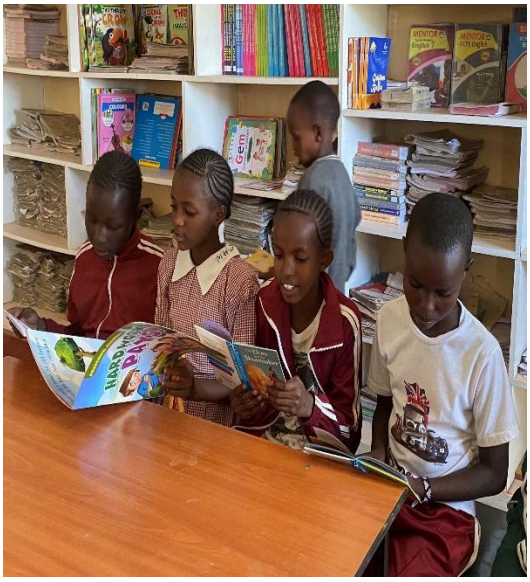
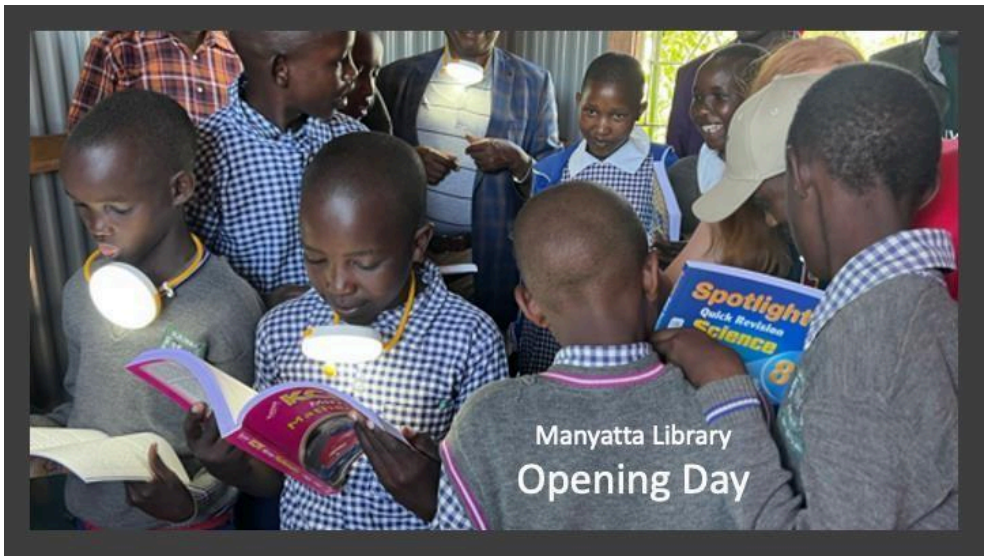


Figure 1 Andrew, the Traditional Manyatta Librarian with Barb Mackraz, Co-Founder, Oliveseed.

This Library will house books, digital resources, and other learning materials for the whole community, as well as a Computer Center and a Meeting Room for literacy classes, computer classes, and business skills training. The Library will be surrounded by indigenous trees with a cultural arboretum suggested by the community. In addition to being a general public resource, this will greatly extend the services offered by our school projects in the area and will be the center of writing programs for students and an indigenous story project with young people interviewing their elders to capture oral stories before they are lost.



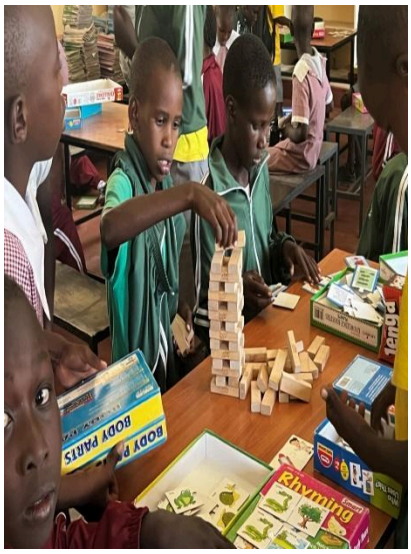


Figure 2 One of Oliveseed projects in 2022 was the first library inside a manyatta (traditional village). Constructed the solar-powered building and also included portable solars for students to take home with a book.

The Library will also include a significant collection on nature and conservation, as this is right in the middle of the most wildlife-rich region of East Africa, with local Maasai as stewards of this heritage and many conservationists and safari guides working here.

ENGAGEMENT FROM PARTNERS

- **Local Community:** Oliveseed Foundation has deep experience and relationships in the local communities in the Mara. The co-founder of Oliveseed Kenya Trust, Amos Kipeen, is a long-time and respected local leader. The community donated 10 acres for this project, and the land is owned by Oliveseed Kenya.
- **Text Book Centre (TBC), Nairobi:** Oliveseed Kenya Trust has an existing partnership with Text Book Centre, the largest supplier to schools and libraries in Kenya, and they provide expertise and implementation. One of their executives is onboarding the Oliveseed Kenya team, and he curates the school libraries, runs capacity-building workshops, and engages teachers to create extra- curricular reading clubs. They are partnering with Oliveseed Kenya Trust on implementation of this Public Library.

Figure 3 Amos Kipeen, Oliveseed Co-Founder in a Panel discussion by Africa Publishing Innovative Fund in Frankfurt, Germany



- **Africa Publishing Innovation Fund:** Oliveseed Kenya was awarded a competitive grant by Africa Publishing Innovation Fund in 2022 to purchase books, digital resources, and other media needed for libraries, plus games and picture books for the youngest ones to make learning fun and engaging. Oliveseed Kenya will direct $15,000 from that grant to this project. (Confirm the exact figures from Amos Kipeen)
- **Educational Institutions:** Wildlife Clubs of Kenya (WCK) and Maasai Mara University are both partnering with Oliveseed Kenya Trust on materials for the library and will use the facility for hosting local education events. WCK is already a partner of Oliveseed on the ongoing school projects.

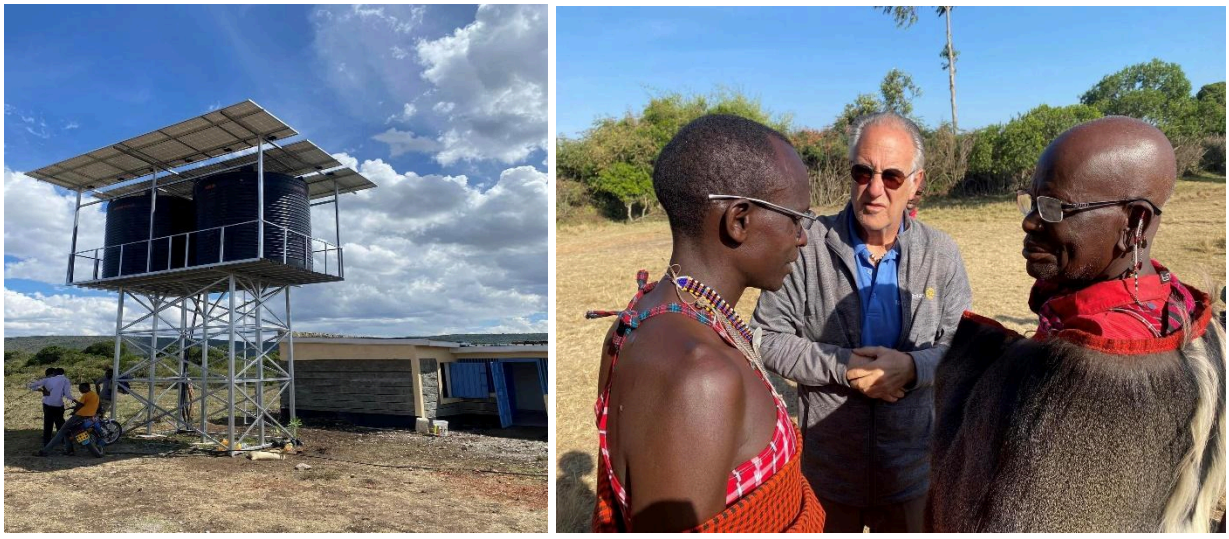
ENGAGEMENT FROM ROTARY

- **Rotary Cash Grants (greatest need):** Oliveseed are seeking cash grants and donations to fund the construction of the Library building. The building is estimated to cost $45,000, as a comprehensive space that includes reading rooms, storage facilities, a server room, a meeting hall for classes and training, and other features. Oliveseed have raised $20,000 so far.
- **Rotary Global Grant:** Oliveseed are working on a Global Grant to fund the furniture of the Library,

solar-powered lighting for night-time literacy activities, latrines, more books and related materials, and the development of literacy classes, computer classes, and vocational and business skills training (curriculum development and "training the trainer").

- **Partner Club in Kenya:** The Kitengela Rotary Club in Nairobi is the Host Club for the Global Grant. Oliveseed has got a great relationship and partnership with this club. The lead on that end, Abigael Pasiany, is President -Elect of the Club and a native Maasai. They have sponsored other projects in the Maasai Mara and are making this their only Grant this Rotary year. The Lavington Rotary Club in Nairobi is also asking to help the project.
- **Pro Bono Architect (Rotarian):** Peter Latey, architect in Los Angeles and member of the Redondo Beach Club, is offering his architecture services pro bono to this project though, Oliveseed will still need to pay drafts-people. Peter has experience with other projects in Kenya.
- **Clean Water (Rotarian):** In fall 2022, Global Water First, run by Rotarian Jon Kaufman, developed a clean water project on this site, including borehole, solar pumping, filtration, and bottling. This facility right next to the Library offers the only clean water in the area, adding to the draw of this location.

Figure 4 Clean Water Project in the Mara Sustainability Centre site.



FINDINGS: Public Library Needs Questionnaire

The following is a summary of the results of a survey of 69 Maasai Mara schools' students conducted between March 7 - 15 March, 2023.

Question 1: What is your age?		
Answer Options	Response Percent	Response Count
Under 12	23.18%	16
12-14	26.1%	18
15-18	14.49%	10
19-25	17.4%	12
26-36 - Teachers	15.94%	11
Prefer not to answer	2.89%	2
	answered question	69

Question 2: How often have you visited the library in the past 12 months?		
Answer Options	Response Percent	Response Count
Did not visit library in the past 12 months.	9.1%	54
1-5 times	20.1%	119
6-12 times	16.1%	95
13-24 times	18.1%	107
More than 24 times	36.5%	216
	answered question	591
	skipped question	7

Note: 29.2% of responses came from individuals who have visited the Library 0-5 times in the past year; 36.5% of responses came from users who visited the Library more than 24 times last year.

Question 3: Would you be more likely to attend a library program presented in a language other than English?		
Answer Options	Response Percent	Response Count
Yes	36.7%	218

No	63.3%	376
	answered question	594
	skipped question	4

Question 4: If yes, which language would you prefer?		
Answer Options	Response Percent	Response Count
Maasai	52.4%	155
	answered question	155

Note: A majority (52.4%) of those who prefer programs in a language other than English prefer Maasai language.

Question 5: Would you be more likely to check out library materials if they were written in a language other than English?		
Answer Options	Response Percent	Response Count
Yes	38.4%	225
No	61.6%	361
	answered question	586
	skipped question	12

Question 6: If yes, which language would you prefer?		
Answer Options	Response Percent	Response Count
Maasai (Traditional)	61.0%	136
	answered question	223

Note: A majority (61%) of those who prefer materials in a language other than English prefer Maasai language materials.

Question 7: How much do you value the following Library services?						
Answer Options	Very Important	Important	Somewhat Important	Not Important	Don't know/Doesn't apply to me	Average Rating 0-4
Access to computers	240	125	81	44	63	2.79
Access to Wi-Fi	324	96	50	28	57	3.08
Books	423	76	22	2	33	3.54
eBooks	169	100	110	61	109	2.29

Programs/classes/workshops for children (ages 0-14 years)	184	110	59	44	154	2.23
Programs/classes/workshops for teens (ages 15-18 years)	155	123	63	50	155	2.13
Programs/classes/workshops for adults	172	137	108	26	108	2.43
Study rooms	189	138	98	38	87	2.55
Individual seating	226	140	75	36	74	2.74
Expert research, career, small business help	119	126	112	62	127	2.09
Online tutoring	112	127	103	67	136	2.02
Staff assistance	274	164	63	4	45	3.12
Self-service options	195	179	84	20	72	2.74
answered question						558
skipped question						38

Note: All services were rated Very Important or Important by a majority of respondents rating services. Highest rated services were Books, Staff Assistance and Access to Wi-Fi.

Question 8: What makes it easier to get what you need at the School, Public Library or Manyatta Library?		
Answer Options	Response Percent	Response Count
Welcoming environment	61.7%	332
Staff assistance	69.1%	372
24 hour, 7 days access to online library collections and services	47.2%	254
Materials, plentiful and easy to find	61.2%	329
Other (please specify): • Friendly staff/Customer service/flexibility (7) • Facility (5) • Technology (4) • Location (2) • Collection (2)		
answered question		538
skipped question		60

Question 9: What makes it hard to get what you need at the School, Public Library or Manyatta Library?		
Answer Options	Response Percent	Response Count
Too crowded	36.1%	131
No place to sit	41.0%	149
Long waits for staff assistance	20.7%	75

Parking	25.6%	93
Lack of materials that interest you	30.6%	111
Difficult to find materials	24.8%	90
Other (please specify): • Noise (20) • Collection (17) o "Many of the books I want are not here." o "Need more copies of popular books for book discussion group." o "Items on hold for a long time; not enough items through Overdrive." • Technology (9) • Hours (7) • Customer service (5) • Policy (fines, charges) (3) • Facility (2) • Language (2)		
	answered question	363
	skipped question	35

Question 10: What's missing? Are there services, programs or materials (print or electronic) not currently offered that you would like to see us add in the future?

Results for this question are presented in order of the frequency of comments (noted in parentheses), from highest frequency to lowest. Key themes included:

More course books (65)
Story books (35)
The integration of Technology (33)
More
Space (17)
Other:

- Water Dispenser (6)
- Curtains (5)
- Air Ventilators (4)

Question 11 (continued): Subthemes and Characteristic Quotes by Theme

Collection (most comments were about increasing the collection of books and digital collection with books mentioned more frequently: 30 to 22).

Books (30)

- "A complete selection of new books, especially those that are CBC-rated."
- More course books

Digital/e-books (22)

- "I really like the introduction of e-books colections that will enable us get more choices of books."
- "I would like to see more digital materials provided for the learners … Let the Mara Sustainability Centre Public Library be the first physical and online library in the the Mara and entire Narok County!"
- Current DVDs & Audio books

Programs (most comments were about adding programs for adults (12), programs in other languages (4), and programs to help people learn to use the computer (5).

Adult programs (12)

- Film, lectures
- Discussion groups
- Specialty (knitting, cooking, baking, beadings)

Programs in other languages (7)

- Story time/kids (2)

Technology (comments were about updating hardware (14), Enabling access (9), Enabling the Wi-Fi connection (5) or updating software (3).

Facility (comments were primarily about increasing study areas for groups (5) and creating quiet areas for students and adults to work separately (4).

"The study room is small so some learners can't join the program. "

"The library desperately needs a quiet computer room for the librarian only."

"There needs to be a define space for teens (young learners) so that the other learners can use the library undisturbed."

Question 12: Would you use a self-service vending machine to check out library books or DVDs if it were in a convenient location such as Mara Sustainability Centre?

Answer Options	Response Percent	Response Count
Yes	49.7%	266
No	50.3%	269
	answered question	535
	skipped question	63

Question 13: Have you ever used the library's Public Computer Room?		
Answer Options	Response Percent	Response Count
Yes	15.0%	156
No	75.0%	304

Listed in order of frequency:

Why?

- Homework (21)
  - "Because I need it to do my homework assignment."
- No computer at home (13)
- Convenience (8)
- Research (7)
- Internet (4)
- Fun/games (4)

Why not?

- No need (125)
- Need more information/didn't know about the computer room (18)
  - "Didn't know there was one."
  - "Did not know if you had to reserve a PC."
  - "Don't know how to use."
- Atmosphere – odors, noise, other patrons (9)
  - "Air condition is not enough and with bad smell in the computer room."
  - "… it's kind of scary and forbidding.:
- Too crowded (8)
- Don't use computers (5)
- Equipment out of date (4)

Question 14: The Library is considering upgrading the Public Computer Room. How would you rate the following possible upgrades?						
Answer Options	Very important	Important	Somewhat important	Not important	Don't know/Doesn't apply to me	Average Rating 0-4
Group study area with large screen or projector	137	131	91	62	102	2.27
Tablets for use in the library	153	108	91	87	85	2.30
Laptops for use in the library	163	108	91	79	83	2.36

Note: The highest rated upgrade was laptops; the lowest was tablets for use in the library.

Question 15: How else could we upgrade the Public Computer Room?

Listed in order of frequency:

Upgrade software (22)

- Windows 10
- Streaming video
- Compatible with schools
- Google Chrome

Upgrade hardware (18)

- Add computers
- Upgrade existing computers
- Printer
- Visual impairment screening and keyboards

Expand (18)

- More rooms/add a room
- More computer stations
- More seats

Information and support (16)

- Dedicated staff/volunteer support for users
- Classes/tutoring
- Information about the computer room

Internet access/bandwidth (16)

Odor/maintenance (11)

- "Better ventilation system. It gets very stuffy and smelly in there."

Policy – extend time limits, restrict use (10)

- "Restrict it to adults. The children and teenagers use the room to talk while the adults want to do work on the computers."
- "Avoidance of using public computers for gaming or digital entertainment (academic/job/career purposes only)."

Reconfigure the space (8)

- "Specified stations for 2 or 3 people for projects; Quiet (adults only) computer area;"
- "Business center (scanning, copying)"

Question 16: Is there anything else we can do to improve the library?

Listed in order of frequency:

Collection (27)

- More books
- Textbooks
- Different languages (including Maasai)
- CDs, DVDs, audio books and e-books

Reconfigure the space (20)

- Separate adults from children
- Quiet spaces for study
- Spaces for socializing
- More individual and group seating

Staff support (18)

- Increase customer service
- Increase number of staff
- Increase bilingual staff

Programs (17)

- Increase programs
- Increase opportunities for children, teens and families to meet and interact
- Cultural programs (local and foreign)
- Expand film offerings
- More classes: languages, cooking, auto repair, computers, networking, afforestation, climate change mitigation.

Facility (16)

- Various recommended upgrades, including drive-through book return

Monitoring (14)

- “Enforce the standards of behavior so that consistent offenders cannot continue to use library services and harass people.”
- Monitor the behavior of teens.
- Monitor the outside of the Library.

Food-yes (12)

- “Please add a coffee shop/refreshment area.”

Food-no (6)

- “Absolutely no eating anywhere in the library. It looks dirty and disgusting. This facility is not a restaurant.”

Hours (9)

- “Explore possibility keeping it open on Sundays (at least 1/2 day).”

Noise (9)

- “I am not sure how one can keep people from talking on their mobile phones, but it surely would be helpful, especially in the study booth areas.”

Web access (8)

Expand (8)

Internet/Wi-Fi connection (5)

FINDINGS: Focus Groups and Community Forums

The comments of the 42 Library stakeholders who participated in a gathering to consider the future of the library (either a focus group or community forum) are summarized below in three categories, reflecting the common structure of the dialogs:

- Strengths and Best Features of Library
- The Ideal Future for the Library
- Recommendations for Improvements/Enhancement to the Library

Figure 5 Learners in a library session in one of the schools in the Mara.



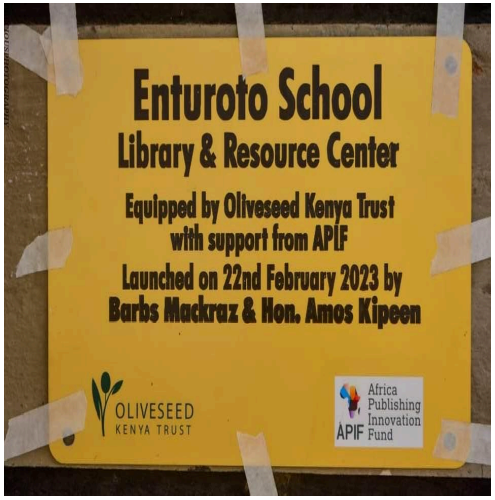
Key results are presented (generally) in order of the frequency of comments, from highest frequency to lowest. Names of specific group participants are not used in this summary. Quotation marks [““] designate remarks by a specific participant.

I. STRENGTHS AND BEST FEATURES OF THE LIBRARY

Figure 6 Amos Kipeen, Oliveseed Kenya Co-Founder, at a school library launch recently in a local school, Enturoto Pri.







Community Members had many positive things to say about the Library. The most frequently mentioned assets or strengths of the Library were (in order of frequency):

- Staff and the level of service provided were mentioned as strengths in all five stakeholder gatherings.
    - Friendly, strong, superb, helpful, forward-looking, open-minded, supportive
- Children's programs (4 out of 5 groups)
    - After school program for students
- The store (4 out of 5 groups)
- The collection of books and other materials (4 out of 5 groups)
    - Best sellers
    - Children's books
    - Textbooks – CBC rated books
    - Large print
- English Conversation classes (3 out of 5 groups)

- Technology (3 out of 5 groups)
    - One-on-one computer tutoring

In addition, the following strengths were mentioned in 2 of the 5 groups: Outreach programs, programs at the Mara Sustainability Centre (e.g. concerts, films, lectures), hours, study spaces, location, gathering place.

II. IDEAL FUTURE FOR THE LIBRARY.

When asked to share their thoughts about the ideal future or 'best case scenario' for the Library, participants offered a number of ideas. Themes emerged across groups, including (in order of frequency):

- Collaboration with schools, *(Between Aitong Primary and Olkimitare – There exist a good collaboration)*, cultural groups and *economic empowerment* was a theme that was common to all five gatherings.
- An environment welcoming of all cultures. (All gatherings)
    - Creating and collaboration space
    - Easily reconfigured for different size groups
    - Library as gathering space for learners
    - Physical space reflects the community

- Bigger space and/or reconfiguration of space to accommodate the needs of multiple user groups. (All gatherings)
    - Information desk
    - House growing collection
    - Increased study & community rooms
    - Drive through book return
    - Comfortable outdoor space with seating also mentioned in more than

one gathering:

- Increased availability of technology, including e-Books. (2 of 5 gatherings)
    - Increased integration of technology: remain 'ahead of the curve'
    - 'Ubiquitous access'

- Access to tablets and other devices
- Dedicated recreation space. (2 of 5 gatherings)
  - More fun gathering place
  - Play area with oversight

III. RECOMMENDED IMPROVEMENTS/ENHANCEMENTS.

Participants in the focus groups, interviews and community meetings contributed a broad range of ideas about improving the library and moving it closer to the ideal described above. Recommendation themes (in order of frequency) were:

- 'Improve Library PR' was a theme common to all groups.
  - Increased use of Facebook, Twitter, and other social media
  - Branding
  - Get our story out there/Engage in library advocacy
  - Send program information to key stakeholders in the area
- Increase accessibility/ease of use with signs, a directory, and an orientation. (4 of 5 gatherings)
  - "Map quest for Books" location finder
  - Brochure for orienting new people to the library
  - Announcements on video screen of programs, etc.
  - Easier sign-up for programs (integrate sign up time into program itself so that people aren't waiting around in a line but are interacting in a meaningful way while they are being 'processed')
  - Translation for immigrants
    - Materials
    - Interpretation during programs
    - Host a weekly "How to use your library" tutorial in English and Local dialect.
- Increase and enhance technology at the Library. (4 of 5 gatherings)
  - Increase computers, printers to attract, engage young people
  - Basic computer skills classes

- More programs for children, including games and other fun activities. (4 of 5 gatherings)
    - Library is the place for a play date, meet other children
    - Foster interaction among children of similar ages
    - More cross-generational programs, sharing with children, youth
- Expand/reconfigure space for Library patrons. (3 of 5 gatherings)
    - Quiet space
    - Loud/collaborative space
    - Kids space
- Increase outreach and information within the community. (3 of 5 gatherings)
    - Share 'evolving state of the library' with the broader community ("Liaise with the Librarian")
    - Staff outreach to community groups; speakers from library
    - Signage at events in the community

- Increase funding (resources - Incentives) and staff for the Library. (3 of 5 gatherings) Also

mentioned:

- Classes in local dialect - Maasai. (2 of 5 gatherings)
- Better/faster Wi-Fi. (2 of 5 gatherings)

FINDINGS: Questionnaire

Question 1: How often have you visited the library in the past 12 months?				
Answer Options				
	Response Percent	Response Count	Response Percent	Response Count
Did not visit library in the past 12 months.	9.4%	39	7.0%	11
1-5 times	18.5%	77	25.9%	41
6-12 times	14.6%	61	19.6%	31
13-24 times	19.9%	83	14.6%	23
More than 24 times	37.6%	157	32.9%	52
answered question		417		158
skipped question		4		2

Note: Aitong Primary learners, Talek Primary learners are more frequent users of the Library than users from Olkimitare Primary (With No Specified Library).

FINDINGS: Questionnaire

Question 2: How much do you value the following Public Library services, School & Manyatta Library?							
	Answer Options	Very Important	Important	Somewhat Important	Not Important	Don't know/Doesn't apply to me	Average Rating
Aitong School	Access to computers	172	86	62	30	39	2.83
Talek School	Access to computers	63	39	17	14	19	2.74
Maasai Mara Secondary	Access to Wi-Fi	230	69	36	21	33	3.14
Enturoto Primary	Access to Wi-Fi	85	27	13	7	22	2.95
Aitong Primary	Books	296	57	17	2	19	3.56
Mararienda	Books	121	17	3	0	12	3.54

Primary							
Aitong School	eBooks	121	74	81	44	69	1.89
Talek School	eBooks	46	25	26	17	34	1.76
Maasai Mara Secondary	Expert research, career,	83	88	87	45	83	2.30
Aitong School	Individual seating	156	99	60	28	45	2.28
Talek School	Individual seating	66	40	13	8	24	1.79
Aitong School	Online tutoring	86	95	73	49	83	2.44
Talek School	Online tutoring (with tutor.com)	23	31	29	17	47	2.46
Maasai Mara Sec	Programs/classes/workshops for adults	118	101	78	20	72	2.67
Aitong School	Programs/classes/workshops for adults	53	33	26	6	32	2.32
Arcadia	Programs (ages 0-14 years)	132	83	45	32	99	2.76
Olkimitare School	Programs (ages 0-14 years)	48	25	12	12	51	2.77
Maasai Mara Sec	Programs (ages 15-18 years)	117	94	48	33	94	2.11
Talek School	Programs (ages 15-18 years)	36	26	13	17	56	2.11
Aitong School	Self-service options	144	121	64	13	47	2.13
Enturoto School	Self-service options	48	55	17	6	23	1.77
Manyatta Library	Staff assistance	188	119	48	4	29	3.12
Aitong School	Study rooms	143	103	67	27	50	2.78
Maasai Mara Secondary	Study rooms	45	32	30	10	32	2.66

FINDINGS: Questionnaire

Question 3: What makes it easier to get what you need at the Public Library, School & Manyatta Library?				
Answer Options				
	Response Percent	Response Count	Response Percent	Response Count
Welcoming and conducive environment	63.5%	240	57.3%	86

Staff /Librarian assistance	67.2%	254	74.7%	112
Materials, plentiful and easy to find	63.2%	239	59.3%	89
answered question		378		150
skipped question		43		10

Question 4: What makes it hard to get what you need at the Public Library, School & Manyatta Library?				
Answer Options				
	Response Percent	Response Count	Response Percent	Response Count
Too crowded	36.9%	96	36.1%	35
No place to sit	43.5%	113	33.0%	32
Long waits for staff assistance	18.8%	49	23.7%	23
Parking	26.9%	70	22.7%	22
Lack of materials that interest you	33.5%	87	24.7%	24
Difficult to find materials	25.0%	65	23.7%	23
answered question		260		97
skipped question		61		63

Question 5: Have you ever used the library's Public Computer Room?				
Answer Options				
	Response Percent	Response Count	Response Percent	Response Count
Yes	44.7%	172	40.8%	60
No	55.3%	213	59.2%	87
answered question		385		147
skipped question		36		13

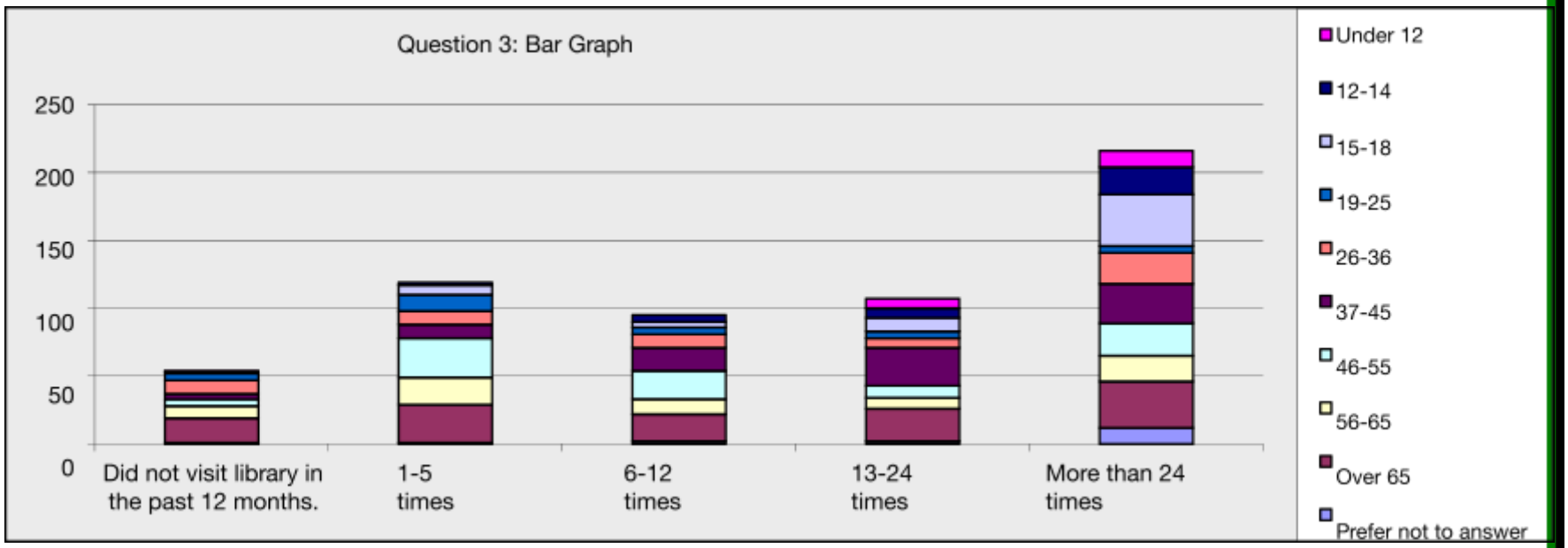
FINDINGS: Questionnaire

Question 6: The Library is considering upgrading the Public Computer Room. How would you rate the following possible upgrades?							
Location	Answer Options	Very important	Important	Somewhat important	Not important	Don't know/Doesn't apply to me	Rating Average
Aitong School	Group study area w/ screen or projector	105	96	68	39	66	2.36
Talek School	Group study area w/ screen or projector	31	32	23	23	31	2.06
Maasai Mara School	Laptops for use in the library	120	73	69	55	56	2.39
Talek School	Laptops for use in the library	41	34	19	25	23	2.32
Aitong School	Tablets for use in the library	115	73	71	60	55	2.36
Manyata Library	Tablets for use in the library	36	34	18	28	25	2.20

FINDINGS: By Age Group

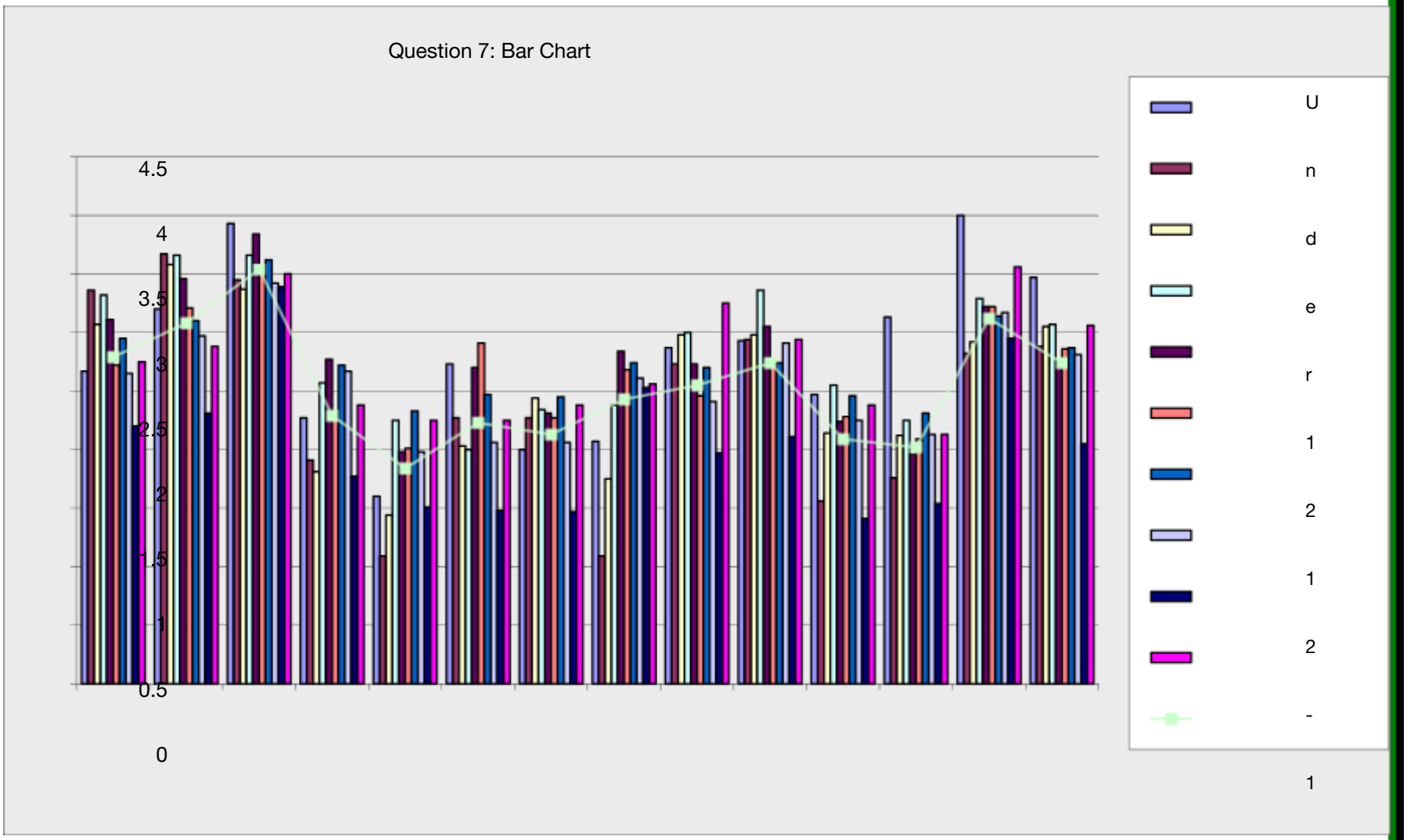
Answer Options	Under 12	12-14	15-18	19-25	26-36	Prefer not to answer
Did not visit library in the past 12 months.	1	0	1	5	10	1
1-5 times	0	2	7	12	10	1

6-12 times	0	5	4	5	10	2
13-24 times	7	7	10	5	7	2
More than 24 times	90	254	170	55	10	12
591						



Question 7: How much do you value the following Library services?										
	What is your age?									
Answer Options	Under 12	12-14	15-18	19-25	26-36	37-45	46-55	56-65	Over 65	Prefer not to answer
Access to computers										
Very Important	6	21	30	15	30	30	39	29	32	8
Important	4	7	9	8	13	20	24	11	27	2
Somewhat Important	2	2	16	4	8	17	10	9	11	2
Not Important	0	2	2	1	2	6	9	5	15	2
Don't know/Doesn't apply to me	3	1	2	0	4	8	5	11	27	2
	2.67	3.36	3.07	3.32	3.11	2.72	2.95	2.65	2.20	2.75
Access to Wi-Fi										
Very Important	9	26	45	23	40	43	55	37	37	9
Important	3	5	8	2	7	20	12	10	27	2
Somewhat Important	1	1	3	4	6	12	5	6	11	1
Not Important	1	0	1	0	1	4	4	3	12	2
Don't know/Doesn't apply to me	1	1	2	0	2	2	11	9	27	2
	3.20	3.67	3.58	3.66	3.46	3.21	3.10	2.97	2.31	2.88
Books										
Very Important	14	25	37	21	53	64	67	47	84	11
Important	1	2	12	6	3	9	15	10	15	3
Somewhat Important	0	4	7	2	1	1	1	2	3	1
Not Important	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	1
Don't know/Doesn't apply to me	0	2	2	0	1	6	4	6	12	0
	3.93	3.45	3.37	3.66	3.84	3.56	3.62	3.42	3.39	3.50
eBooks										
Very Important	2	9	9	9	24	24	35	25	28	4
Important	6	1	6	6	11	13	21	16	15	5
Somewhat Important	3	10	20	7	9	20	14	11	13	3
Not Important	2	4	13	4	8	10	3	1	15	1
Don't know/Doesn't apply to me	2	9	11	2	4	13	13	11	41	3
	2.27	1.91	1.81	2.57	2.77	2.31	2.72	2.67	1.77	2.38

FINDINGS: By Age Group (continued)



19-25

26-36

37-45

46-55

56-65

Over 65

Prefer not to

answer

Rating

Average

LITERACY LEVELS OF EDUCATION IN NAROK COUNTY

Kenya adult literacy rate was at level of 82.6 % in 2021, up from 81.5 % in 2018. Adult (15+) literacy rate (%). Total is the percentage of the population age 15 and above who can, with understanding, read and write a short, simple statement on their everyday life. Generally, 'literacy' also encompasses 'numeracy', the ability to make simple arithmetic calculations. This indicator is calculated by dividing the number of literates aged 15 years and over by the corresponding age group population and multiplying the result by 100.

Education sector in Narok County is geared towards creating a just and cohesive society through participatory engagement, provision of quality education and training. Amongst the many roles of the sector is to provide quality ECDE training through development of ECDE centers, recruitment of ECDE and primary school teachers; promote vocational training and education in the County through expansion and modernization of Vocational Training Centers (VTCs) and skills based vocational trainings; improve access to primary and secondary education.

The literacy levels of in the county in the last five years has increased from 63% to 67%, ECDE enrolment improved from 53,027 to 69,030, number of ECDE caregivers increased from 475 to 1,388, primary teacher pupil ratio improved from 1: 110 to 1:53 and the number of school centers increase from 604 to 695. Transition rate increased from 82% to 89% and the primary school enrolment increased from 219,699 to 239,948 and the number schools increased from 585 to 664 including 19 special schools; secondary school teacher to pupil ratio improved from 1:62 to 1:40 and teaching force increased from 600 to 775 and the number of vocational centers improved from 7 to 9 centers.

Among the challenges the education sector is facing is a drop in secondary school enrolment from 37,210 to 31,252; transition rate from primary to secondary school dropped to 53% from 59%; transition rate from secondary schools to university currently stands at 7% which is way below the expected level; and the number of Adult and Continuing Education Centers dropped from 117 to 111. In addition, Narok County has one public university and four tertiary colleges, namely: Maasai Mara Technical, Narok West Technical Training Institute, Narok Teachers and Ludepe Colleges situated in Narok town.

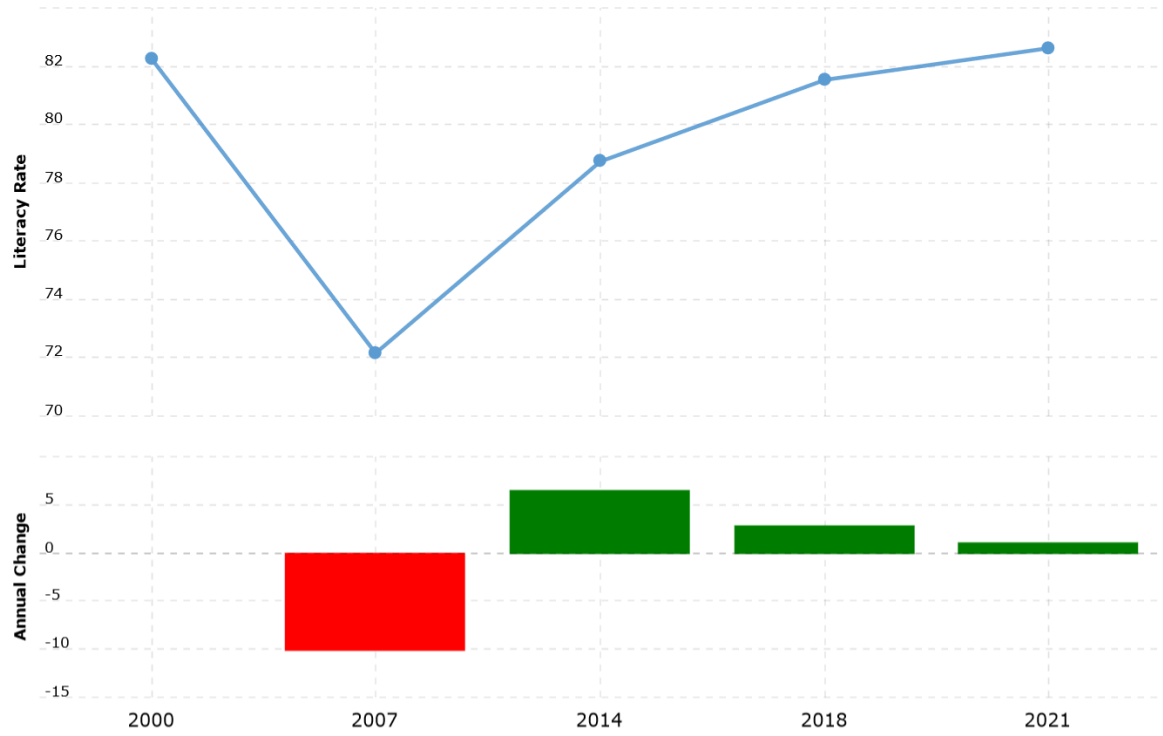


Figure 7 Kenya Literacy Rate 2000-2023

EDUCATION ASSESSMENT IN THE MAASAI MARA

The number of candidates who scored 400 marks and above in the Kenya Certificate of Primary Education (KCPE) examination in Narok County increased from 46.5 percent compared to the previous year, setting the stage for a scramble for admission to the coveted national secondary schools. Aitong and Talek Primary schools reported an improved number of pupils attending National schools in the last 5 years.

The Mara Girls Leadership School which is a model school and a beneficiary of the school library project by Oliveseed, established to mentor a generation of community transformational leaders by providing secure and quality primary education for talented girls from Koiyaki Sub County and ensure successful graduation into high school has been attaining a 75% transition of learners to National Schools.

The lack of continuity of education means that many children fail to continue their education after the free primary school, due to lack of money. If they are able to finish secondary school, the only option in the area is the polytechnic school. To study elsewhere means extra costs. Many local youngsters would like to stay in their home village, but also study or work properly.

Table 4. The problem matrix of Aitong, Emarti village. The classes: T/E = technical or economic problems, E = environmental problems, S = sociological problems.

Rank	Problem	Severity	Class	Positive change	Negative change	Net
1	Lack of career guidance	57	T/E	1	17	-16
2	Wildlife animals problem	50	E	1	19	-18
3	Water problems	37	E	6	9	-3
4	Lack of medical facilities	35	T/E	8	8	0
5	Transport and communication	31	T/E	15	2	+13
5	Lack of continuity of education	31	T/E	17	0	+17
7	Lack of mentorship	29	E, T/E	2	15	-13
7	Lack of land (Youths in the Mara don't have land)	29	T/E	15	0	+15
9	Lack of resources for projects	27	T/E	16	0	+16
10	Lack of adequate energy	24	T/E	14	5	+9
11	Poor marketing sites	23	T/E	0	16	-16
12	Lack of unity	22	S	8	6	+2
13	Poor housing	20	T/E	9	3	+6
14	Lack of polytechnic facilities	19	T/E	0	17	-17
15	Effects of climatic changes	14	E	1	19	-18
Total change		113		136		-23

Human resource features were assessed also with high marks. There are skilled, local people, who can interpret the natural and cultural features of the area. The assessors assumed, that the educated, young people could be interested in developing business management skills, digital literacy if needed. The Mara Sustainability Centre comes in handy on this aspect.

COMMUNITY-BASED ECOTOURISM

According to assessment, the term "community-based ecotourism ventures" should be used to distinguish those initiatives that are environmentally conscious while also aiming to ensure that local residents have a high degree of control over the activities that take place and receive a significant portion of the benefits. The Ecotourism Society of Kenya defines ecotourism as “responsible travel to natural areas that conserves the environment and sustains the well-being of the people. On development terms, ecotourism is tourism that meets the needs of the present generation without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their needs from the same resources”. Unlike ecotourism firms controlled solely by foreign operators, this is also distinct from situations in which the government reaps the majority of the economic benefits of tourism. Even if the adage "wildlife pays, therefore wildlife survives" applies to East Africa, Maasai Mara, it has mostly "paid" for governments, foreign tourism businesses, and local entrepreneurs rather than providing advantages to local communities.

Ecotourism has been variously defined. All definitions of ecotourism emphasize that it must take place in natural areas, which could include state managed protected areas, private land or communal land. The key criteria for ecotourism are:

- The activity must be environmentally and culturally sensitive;
- Must directly benefit conservation and local people who in turn have an incentive for conservation; and

it

- Must be self-sustaining within the context of the natural and cultural habitats in which it takes place.

The primary objective of ecotourism management is to conserve the natural and cultural diversity while secondarily providing for an acceptable level of tourism or recreation. This prioritizing probably refers to the threats ecotourism poses if not well planned.

However, unless the requirements of safeguarding the environment are met, ecotourism is in danger of being a self- destructive process, destroying the very resources upon which it is based.

The interdependence of tourism and the social and physical environment is fundamental for the future of each. A significant shift has happened in tourism industry during recent decades and interest in ecotourism has grown exponentially. Community- based natural resource management is being increasingly promoted as the way to tackle the environmental problems and to emphasize community empowerment in the Maasai Mara Ecosystem.

The recent Maasai Mara Management plan, Greater Mara and Ecosystem Plan and the Narok County Spatial plans documents that were gazette to be law by both the county and national government has come at a strategic time that this jewel ecosystem needs to be preserved and the eco-tourism components have been mentioned elaborately.

THE EXISTING AND POTENTIAL ROLE OF ECOTOURISM IN THE AREA´S ECONOMY

When discussing about the demand for community-based ecotourism ventures in Maasai Mara, it is necessary to look at the estimations about the importance of ecotourism to Kenya´s economy in a nation-wide scale. It is important to notice the difference between the demand for soft ecotourism and hard ecotourism.

One notable result of the assessment is the lack of congruency between the strong popular market image of these destinations as ecotourism destinations and the actual magnitude of such specialized facilities, tourists and activity space, as well as direct environmental, socio-cultural and economic impacts and government expenditures. There is, however, a big difference, when assessed on the basis of total tourist activity time used for ecotourism, which is estimated as substantial. Also the visitor motivation and indirect revenue generation are major phenomenon’s, more corresponding to the public image of ecotourism.

In addition, ecotourism proponents argue that it benefits the local community by including them into the experience. While this is true, previous studies have shown there will be differences in how the tourist industry affects people based on their gender, class, or other traits. Ethical tourism has no reason to vary in this regard.

Ecology-oriented marketing materials frequently use homogeneous language when talking about "the local people" and "the local community." Conservationists, rather than developers, have a strong effect on local ecotourism efforts, which may account for some of this.

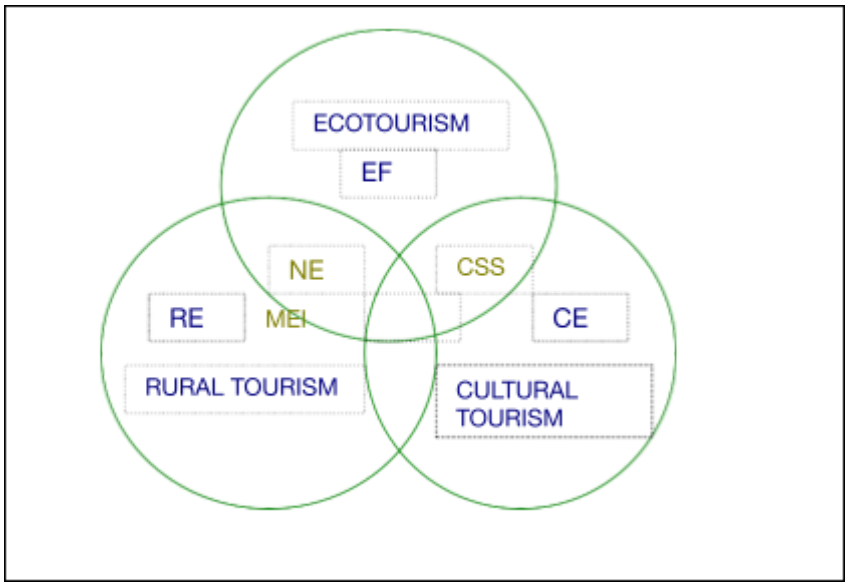


Figure 3. *Characteristics of ecotourism, rural tourism and cultural tourism. EF= eco-activities as the focus, CE= cultural experiences as the focus, RE= rural experience as the focus, NE= natural element, MEI= minimum environmental impact, CS= cultural sensitivity.*

CULTURAL TOURISM.

Cultural tourism is characterized by visits to local communities perceived to still maintain and practice ancestral traditions and cultural ways. Tourists are attracted by peoples´ traditional lifestyles, cultural practices and economic activities among other aspects of community living. Visitors may participate in dance and music, festivals, buying local artifacts and shooting photos (Ecotourism Society of Kenya 2005: 9). Cultural tourism places its´ primary emphasis on the cultural component. Tour operators in Kenya and Maasa Mara have become aware of the need to diversify the country´s tourism product from wildlife and beach-based attractions to include diverse aspects of people´s cultures in Kenya. Tourists are always in search of interesting, thrilling and surprising experiences. They are always aware of their state of alienation and desires to experience the environment and culture of others.



Figure 8 Oloirien Women's Centre

Communities have become more diverse and complicated throughout time, but environmentalists continue to consider them as tiny, homogenous groups with a common social structure and shared norms. Because it is easy to contrast "the state" or "private enterprise," this community picture is appealing, but it is necessary to better comprehend the multitude of people, interests, institutions, and processes that are present in each particular region.

Rural tourism means visiting and staying in places or destination areas perceived to be not influenced by urbanization and its impacts. Such places would be characterized by low industrialization, low population density, subsistence and primary economic activities and unsophisticated community life styles. Tourists visit such places to experience and participate in rural life styles and stay in rustic accommodation among other activities. Backpackers and specialist tourists favor this type of tourism

Figure 9 Oloirien Women Centre



PURPOSE OF THE ASSESSMENT

When considering whether or not a community have been economically empowered by an ecotourism venture, it is necessary to consider opportunities which have arisen in terms of both formal and informal sector employment and business opportunities.

While some economic gains are usually experienced by a community, problems may develop if these are periodic and cannot provide a regular, reliable income. This study assessed the effects of the eco-tourism industry in community settings.

ASSESSMENT METHODOLOGY

The descriptive method of assessment was used and the descriptive response of the respondent's group and the characteristics of the population under study. The schema of the flow of this assessment was based on the concept of Input-Process-Output (IPO) model which is a widely used approach in describing the structure of an information processing and for other processes.

This assessment was conducted in 5 lodges present in the Maasai Mara Community and a cultural maasai Manyatta. The participants of the assessment were local communities and local lodge managers.

FINDINGS: Results and Discussions

Table 1. **Environmental Effects of Ecotourism Industry**

Environmental Effects of Ecotourism Industry	Conservancies, Lodge Managers & National Museum of Kenya, Narok Branch.		Community Representatives	
It enhances the preservation of the ecosystem.	3.24	MA	3.12	MA
It makes people realize the importance of environmental conservation due to their sensitivity to environmental change and abuse.	3.02	MA	4.01	A
It maintains and protects the natural resources through implementing standard rules and regulations such as the leave no trace principles, no littering and no to quarrying, etc.	3.62	A	3.16	MA
It implements programs or projects for proper waste management for local residents and tourists in the Mara Ecosystem.	4.02	A	3.10	MA
It maintains the outdoor natural environment of the Mara and increase the health benefit of people who engage in cultural activities.	4.01	A	3.04	MA
It provides the tourists fun, relaxing, or invigorating vacation experience without harming the environment.	3.26	MA	3.12	MA
It encourages the local residents to use environmentally friendly materials like paper bags instead of plastic.	3.12	MA	4.02	A
It contributes to the preservation of the environment, and more generally, promote the preservation of nature and culture.	3.22	MA	3.26	MA
It offers environmental activities like planting trees and clean-up programs.	4.02	A	3.12	MA
GRAND MEAN	3.57	A	3.31	MA

Table 1 highlights the environmental effects of eco-tourism industry. Finding shows that conservancies and lodge officials rated environmental effects of eco-tourism industry with an overall weighted mean of 3.57 which

verbally described as agree. The statement refers to Income and taxes from these businesses can be used for the conservation of the natural environment of Maasai Mara got the highest weighted mean of 4.21 which verbally described as strongly agree, while the statement makes people realize the importance of environmental conservation due to their sensitivity to environmental change and abuse got the lowest weighted mean of 3.02 which also verbally described as moderately agree.

Community respondents on the other hand, environmental effects of eco-tourism industry got a final overall mean of 3.31 which verbally described as moderately agree. The statement refers to it encourages the local residents to use environmentally friendly materials like paper bags instead of plastic garnered the highest weighted mean of 4.02 which verbally described as agree, it maintains the outdoor natural environment of Mara.

As the respondent groups envision the environmental effect eco-tourism in their community, it can be notice that there is a still a need to uplift the connection between community and local officials to preserve and protect our natural resources from danger and abuse. Rising tourism puts greater pressure on regions to expand and become more inclusive and resort-like. More housing, settlements, and facilities inside these touristic destinations and attractions harm and destroy environments. By causing damage to the local ecology, you put more strain on native species. As a result, it is critical to implement policies that keep the environment safe from harm and exploitation.

Table 2. **Economic Effects of Ecotourism Industry**

Economic Effects of Ecotourism Industry	Conservancies, Lodge Managers & National Museum of Kenya, Narok Branch.		Community Representatives	
It provides employment for local residents in services like accommodation and tour guiding in walking and nature guides activities.	3.41	A	4.24	SA
It creates business opportunities within the community like beading from the local women.	3.82	A	3.89	A
It becomes a tourist attraction and improves socio- economic of local residents.	4.26	SA	4.21	SA

It provides livelihood programs from the donations of tourists and other philanthropists.	4.24	SA	3.44	A
It provides more income for drivers, nature guides, interpreters and operators of the transportation services with the coming of tourists.	4.45	SA	3.22	MA
It provides avenues for fund raising projects that may help in the economic development of the area (Like the Mara Sustainability Centre)	3.89	A	4.21	SA
It develops more flexible employment conditions by creating small businesses that may help the local residents.	4.61	SA	4.01	A
It promotes new set of products and services to tourists i.e tree planting exercise,	4.32	SA	3.62	A
It boosts the local economy by providing camping sites or accommodations to tourists.	4.41	SA	3.68	A
GRAND MEAN	4.17	A	3.90	A

Table 2 presents the economic effects of ecotourism industry. Finding shows that conservancy & lodge managers rated economic effects of ecotourism industry with an overall weighted mean of 4.17 which verbally described as agree.

The statement refers to it provides more income for drivers, nature guides and operators of the transportation services with the coming of tourists got the highest weighted mean of 4.45 which verbally described as strongly agree, while the statement it provides employment for local residents in services like accommodation and camping sites and tour guiding in trekking and hiking, walking safaris activities got the lowest weighted mean of 3.41 which verbally described as agree. Community respondents on the other hand, economic effects of ecotourism industry got a final overall mean of 3.90 which verbally described as agree. The statement refers to it provides more income for drivers and operators of the transportation services with the coming of tourists got the lowest weighted mean of 3.22 which verbally described as moderately agree. Moreover, findings have shown that there is a positive effect of economic for the respondent groups. It can be noted that based on the data that it generates job opportunities among the residents.

Locals will be able to find work through tourism. They can receive the necessary training for the kind of professions for which they may be qualified, rather than relying solely on livestock keeping.

Table 3. **Socio-cultural Effects of Ecotourism Industry**

Socio-cultural Effects of Ecotourism Industry	Conservancies, Lodge Managers & National Museum of Kenya, Narok Branch.		Community Representatives.	
It involves the local community in planning and decision- making.	4.05	A	3.21	MA
It promotes local experiences through learning about activities	4.28	SA	3.27	MA
It promotes local experiences through learning about the physical attributes of place within the local community.	4.02	A	3.46	A
It builds a sense of pride and ownership for residents.	4.10	A	3.28	MA
It builds healthier communities by encouraging local culture, food, and recreation choices.	4.49	SA	3.24	MA
It promotes the sustainability of ecotourism attractions in the City through the participation of residents in programs.	4.25	SA	3.29	MA
It gives opportunity to the local community to interact with people of diverse cultural backgrounds.	4.20	A	3.62	A
It encourages respect between tourists and residents.	4.64	SA	3.81	
It creates a welcoming atmosphere for visitors.	4.83	SA	3.56	A
It provides a greater understanding of local cultural, social, and environmental issues to residents and tourists.	4.28	SA	3.43	A
GRAND MEAN	4.31	SA	3.42	A

Table 3 presents the socio-cultural effects of ecotourism industry. Data shows that conservancy & lodge managers rated socio-cultural effects of ecotourism industry with an overall weighted mean of 4.31 which verbally described as strongly agree.

The statement refers to it creates a welcoming atmosphere for visitors got the highest weighted mean of 4.83 which verbally described as strongly agree, while the statement it promotes local experiences through learning about the physical attributes of place within the local community got the lowest weighted mean of 4.02 which verbally described as agree.

Community respondents on the other hand, socio-cultural effects of ecotourism industry got a final overall

mean of 3.81 which verbally described as agree. The statement refers to it encourages respect between tourists and residents garnered the highest weighted mean of 4.45 which verbally described as agree, while the statement refers to it involves the local community in planning and decision-making got the lowest weighted mean of 3.21 which verbally described as moderately agree.

This indicates that respondent groups perceived socio-cultural that promotes and builds healthier communities by encouraging local and community to participate on the tourism programs in the localities. Tourism is a globalized corporate activity that provides significant obstacles in terms of traditional social culture. Traditional social life at many World Heritage sites has altered considerably as the tourism industry has grown. Furthermore, the rising reliance of many regions' economy on tourism has resulted in an irreversible shift in the mindset of many rural or local people.

The influence of tourist development and its economic efficiency on people' traditional values, lifestyles, and interpersonal relationships in historic villages designated as World Heritage Sites like the Maasai Mara Game Reserve is one example of these modifications. As a result, communities and local authorities must collaborate to develop their links in order to boost the eco-tourism business.

Table 4. **Development and Marketing**

Development and Marketing	Conservancies, Lodge Managers & National Museum of Kenya, Narok Branch.		Community Representatives.	
Implement marketing promotions	4.28	SA	3.82	A
Facilitate investments and lower business cost	4.05	A	3.65	A
Safeguarding and develop natural and cultural resources, and vulnerable groups	4.02	A	4.01	A
GRAND MEAN	4.12	A	3.83	A

Table 4 highlights the development and marketing of the local tourists' spot. All items were assessed as important and implement marketing promotions got the highest weighted mean of 4.28 which verbally described as strongly agree. In the point of view of the respondents, the local and county government should focus first with the implementation of the marketing promotion of the ecotourism.

It was followed by facilitating investments and entrepreneurship cost with a weighted mean of 4.04 which

verbally described as agree and safeguarding and develop natural and cultural resources, and vulnerable groups with a weighted mean of 4.02 which verbally described as agree. Community on the other hands, implement marketing promotions got the highest weighted mean of 3.82 which verbally described as agree, while facilitate investments and lower entrepreneurship cost got the lowest weighted mean of 3.65 which verbally described as agree.

The economic potential of tourism is substantial and following marketing and promotional strategy intends to maximize the benefits tourism can generate. The promotion aims to work alongside a dedicated and professional tourism industry sector to ensure the community maintains and grows its share of the lucrative tourism market.

An assessment tool was used for getting an overall comprehension about the attractions and resources of the Maasai Mara region as well as the region in wider scale (including the adjacent conservancies and nearby lowland areas). The assessment was made by two persons who were originally from Mara and had lived there most of their lives. A comparison assessment was made by the consultant in order to get an "ecotourist point of view".

The characteristics to be assessed in regional scale and the points they scored out of 25 are following:

Table 2. Maasai Mara regional scores.

Regional Characteristics	Local assessment Outsider	Outsider	
• Natural beauty	23	22	
• Cultural and social characteristics	20	18	
• Recreational facilities	21	17	
• Public infrastructure	15	13	
• Accessibility	19	18	
• Attitudes towards visitors	23	21	
• Existing tourism activity	6	4	
Net regional characteristics score:	**7.8**	**7.2**	→ Mean value **7.5**

Following characteristics of Aitong location were

assessed: Table 3. Aitong property scores.

Property Characteristics	Local assessment	Outsider	
• Natural features	21	22	
• Built features and cultural artefacts	19	22	
• Site infrastructure	18	15	
• Human resource features	21	18	
Net property characteristics score	**7.9**	**7.7**	→ Mean value **7.8**

THE PROS AND CONS OF THE USED METHODS

Regarding the nature of the issues studied, it was relevant to use qualitative methods. Attitudes, knowledge and values can only be revealed through interaction between the consultant and the target groups or persons. This applies both to the in-depth interviews and the participatory methods. The benefits of these methods are meant to accrue for both parties. Especially when participatory methods are used, learning is mutual. One constraint of these methods is shortage of time. There never seems to be enough time when using a participatory approach. The visits and longer stays as well as making appointments need plenty of organizing. Certain level of adaptation was also needed in order to get a view into the community as an outsider. In return a lot of fresh data, not found in any books or surveys, was collected.

The factors affecting the reliability of this assessment have to do with the dilemma of how well people understand each other's while communicating. The consultant might interpret some signals and statements in a

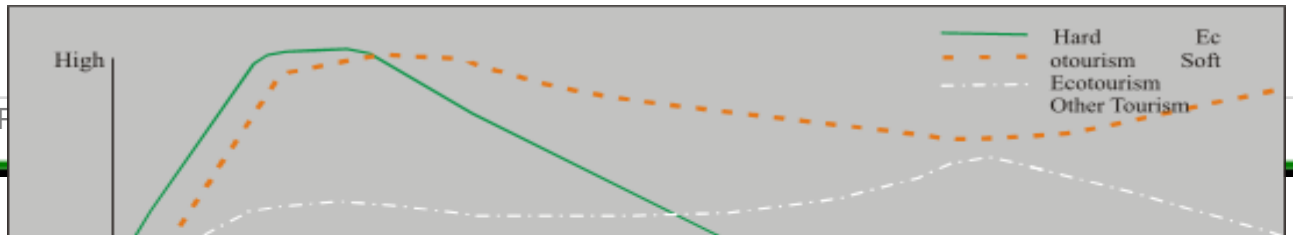
wrong or biased way, not only because of the difference of cultural background, but also because of distracting factors, such as many people talking at the same time during the group interviews. However, the reliability is tried to be maximized by triangulation, i.e. by using various methods for collecting data concerning this certain issue. The assessment target group people represent different social classes and differing interests, which completes the general picture.

ASSESSING THE COMPATIBILITY OF ECOTOURISM WITH PROTECTED AREAS

All protected areas are not equally compatible with ecotourism. The attempts to assess protected areas for ecotourism was hindered by proliferation of protected area designations until the mid-1990s. Any jurisdiction could establish a classification structure needed for calling an area protected. The World Conservation Union (IUCN) responded in 1994 by devising a protected area classification scheme comprising six basic categories, which are now widely accepted as the international standards for protected areas. The lower the designated number of the site is, the lower is the amount of environmental modification and human intervention acceptable.

According to (IUCN 1994) the **Category I** includes Strict Nature Reserves (I a) and Wilderness Areas (I b) reserved for scientific and research purposes or environmental monitoring. They are protected and managed to preserve the area´ s natural condition. **Category II** means National Parks, which are" designated firstly to protect the integrity of ecosystems for present and future generations, secondly exclude exploitation or occupation inimical to the purposes of designation of the area and thirdly to provide a foundation for spiritual, scientific, educational, recreational and visitor opportunities, all which must be environmentally and culturally compatible.

An area containing natural or natural/cultural features, which are of outstanding or unique value because of its inherent rarity, representative or aesthetic qualities or cultural significance, falls under the **Category III**; Natural Monument. The **IV Category** (Habitat/Species Management Area) is an area subject to active intervention for management purposes striving to maintain habitats or meet the requirements of specific species. The human-nature interaction can be seen in **Category V** areas. These are Protected Landscapes or Seascapes of distinct character with aesthetic, ecological or cultural value and often with high biodiversity.



WELL-BEING OF THE COMMUNITY MEMBERS OF THE AREA UNDER STUDY.

According to a participatory study conducted in four villages in the Maasai Mara, namely Olkimitare, Aitong, Enturoto and Emarti, there are common problems affecting the well- being of the local people. Community groups consisting of youths and women of different ages were interviewed and by using matrixes they ranked a great number of problems related to economics, environment and social issues. Among the top six problems, common for all four villages, were:

- Expensive secondary school education
- Lack of rains and access to clean water
- Unemployment
- Poor land ownership
- Lack of investment possibilities and
- Lack of knowledge and exposure.

The poverty reduction remains a deep-rooted challenge in the Maasai Mara. Absolute rural poverty affects especially the aged, the disabled, small holders with less than 0.05 ha, landless, youths, children and female headed households. The area is not self-sufficient in food and the areas depending on seasonal tourists and seasonal rains are vulnerable to unfavorable rainfall conditions. The vicious circle of poverty should be broken as it leads to low savings and investments and further to low productivity, unskilled labor and pressure on the land. When it comes to technical and entrepreneurship skills, if 75% of the Oloirien Women dream of establishing an

economic powerhouse when the established women center starts are operationalized and they agree that this would bring considerable change to their livelihoods.

Figure 11 Oloirien Women's Centre fully completed





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ASSESSING COMMUNITY VIABILITY AND CULTURAL SUSTAINABILITY IN MAASAI MARA.

Loss of forest cover in the Mara Ecosystem

The change of cultural sustainability and social and environmental values as mentioned earlier in the text has also altered the human-forest relation. The general knowledge about Maasai traditions has diminished as well as the traditional ecological knowledge. People with good knowledge for example about indigenous plants with medicinal value are hard to find. When asking people about the old religious traditions and beliefs, it seems as if they mostly like to talk about it in secrecy. There are people believing and practicing old rituals, but nobody probably knows how many they are nowadays.

A study conducted in Mau forest in Kenya has identified the underlying causes of deforestation in the area. The underlying causes affect indirectly and they are based on national and international measures. The causes mentioned are:

- weak policy formulation and enforcement,
- macro-economic policies such as an increase in cash crop production for export
- structural adjustment
- population pressure and
- trade liberalization

Comparable results appeared in the assessment concerning the causes of forest loss in the Mara. An increase in resource demand along with increasing economic dependence on forest resources hinder conservation efforts as poverty incidences increase due to the population growth.

The afforestation and climate mitigation mechanism as anticipated in the ideology of the Mara Sustainability centre is motivated by and as alluded by the community members by the following benefits;

- Collection of medicinal herbs;
- Harvesting of honey;
- Grass harvesting and grazing;
- Collection of forest produce for community- based industries;
- Ecotourism and recreational activities,

- Scientific and education activities;
- Plantation establishment through non-resident cultivation;
- Development of community wood and non-wood forest based industries.

DIMINISHING CULTURAL ASPECTS IN THE MARA AND WHY IT IS A RALLYING CALL TO RESCUE IT.

Cultural tours in Masai Mara is One of the most unique safari part of Masai Mara national reserve with the rest of the parks and reserves is that its managed by the local community. The Masaai tribe dominate the reserve which leave in harmony with wildlife as they practice their traditional way of tradition. According to Muncheri Ole Nche, tourism is one of the main forces absorbing indigenous peoples into the modernist world system and the Maasai culture, like many other indigenous groups are facing these challenges every day. “Indigenous tourism often focuses on the relationships between people and their natural habitat. Apart from the cultural aspect of the Maasai Mara tourism, the various traditional systems of the maasai people affects how people protect and preserve their natural habitats. According to village elder Muncheri Ole Nchoe, the clans have their own places in the forests or caves for sacrificing to higher powers. Initiation training and rainmaking rituals are practiced in these sacred forests. It is forbidden to cut trees or collect firewood from the holy forests. Indigenous plant and tree species can be found on the patches. These sacred forests have had many purposes. In former days they were considered as crucial in protecting the community from bad- intentioned intruders. They acted as a gateway between the homeland in the hills and the lowland areas considered dangerous. In every social unit there has been an elder responsible for rituals. Many important preparations concerning traditional laws and village governance took place in forest. For example, certain plants proved to useful in making medicine for bringing love to the community if the situation seemed unsettled. The purification of the elder, and judging and sentencing wrong doers took place in a sacred forest as well. According to Muncheri, the Maasai ritual complex has been even something more than just protecting territory and bringing rain. The food chain was controlled by magical means to suite livestock production and the rainy season’s timing was directed by the elders. There are indigenous forests which are traditionally protected and this show a high level of endemism and the management system in these forests derives from the pre-colonial society. The types of traditionally protected forests (TPFs) differ. There are reasons for protecting, which are directly related to spirituality. However, there are more reasons, than was commonly understood in earlier research, which have to do with secular matters and environmentally motivated factors. The most important forest type has to do with rain calling. There are

also forests for hiding, trials and initiation. The integrity of the areas has been based on taboos and sanctions. They did not consider sacred forests as being significant in environmental management. The performing of rituals has reduced in the past 30 years, because there are no persons left who have these skills. The cultural heritage has not been passed too efficiently. There has even occurred illegal tree cutting in traditionally protected forests. The assessment offers a good point of comparison to the Mara Ecosystem and the means of the interdependency of culture and natural resource management. This is very significant on the climate mitigations solutions to curb the endemic climate change crisis. In the Maasai Mara Ecosystem the indigenous forests are still important places for collecting plants for medicinal use in health care means, although their value has diminished due to the growing awareness about western medicine. The knowledge about traditional use of plants has diminished during the past decades, as people seem to find it easier to buy the cure for an illness from a pharmacy and lack of proper knowledge about herbalism makes them unsure of how to treat especially children. According to the village elder Muncheri, the biggest changes in forest use have occurred during the last 40 years. Local people used to respect and value certain indigenous tree species more and in general trees were felled with consideration. Nowadays agroforestry has been adopted, but the species favored are mostly exotic and their felling more or less care free and often dictated by a need for income. Access to the caves has traditionally been denied from women and local women still do not go into them.

ASSESSMENT TOOL, RESULTS AND COMMUNITY GOALS OF THE CASE AREAS OF MAASAI MARA.

The indigenous forest areas with their surroundings were chosen as cases in order to assess their attractions and magnetism. The same assessment tool was used as in Aitong village, where the Mara Sustainability centre is located at. There were three assessors per area giving their opinions; one local resident, one conservation professional from Maasai Mara Wildlife Conservation Association and the undersigned. Information about ecotourism initiatives and other alternative livelihoods was given by the MMWCA –staff working in the area as well as the game ranger.

CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATIONS.

This assessment aimed at identifying the existing and potential resources as well as recognizing the hindrances for ecotourism development in the Maasai Mara region. The question posed was; What *kind of potential for community-based ecotourism exists in the Maasai Mara and in the area´ s adjacent communities and the establishment of community public libraries? Could ecotourism help to prevent the degradation of the indigenous cultures and forests? And the existence of assets and resources available in Maasai Mara;* ecotourism image, ecotourism development and sustainability. The answers have revealed through the collage of knowledge, experiences and opinions of different level stakeholders heard in this assessment.

The sub-objectives of the assessment were as follows:

1) *to find out the perceptions and opinions of local people about ecotourism, community public libraries.*
2) *to study the interdependency of the local ecosystem and community viability.*
3) *to study locals´ capacity and level of empowerment in managing the natural resources and economic viability of the area (Taking into accounts; Youths & Women).*
4) *to study what kind of ecotourism would be suitable for the area.*
5) *To find out the viability of the already established libraries in selected schools and manyatta.*

Maasai Mara and its adjacent villages has potential for ecotourism development. The local people interviewed in this assessment considered the establishment of a community education and eco-tourism centre as timely and a welcomed idea and thought that it would bring a lot benefits needed in the region. They emphasized the role of ecotourism as a stimulant for the fading indigenous knowledge about cultural traditions and forest species. There seemed to be a common concern of traditions fading in Maasai Mara and its environs. Only the elderly people are well aware about history and traditional ways of life. The middle-aged people confess, that their capacity to tell their children about these things is rather limited, even if they wish they could do that. The young people again learn facts about the environment and history at school, but this kind of learning and emphasizing of issues differs from learning indigenous knowledge

within one´s own family.

Ecotourism means many things to different individuals, especially in local communities. According to the findings, the tourist sector cannot maintain itself without the assistance of community and local government units, which were cited in many local people' and lodge and conservancies officials' interpretations of sustainable tourism. As a result, guaranteeing the long-term viability of tourists' growth necessitates maintaining a high level of knowledge and strong commitment among stakeholders on critical topics such as quality assurance, cultural tourism and sustainable practices. The county government may help the growth of ecotourism by allocating a budget for promotion and preservation of the tourist attraction. Local citizens' participation in the execution of the tourism development plan is very key as they are the main stakeholders.

Nothing defines a country and makes it unique like its culture. Seeing its art, experiencing its traditions, trying its cuisine and strolling through its history are without doubt the best guides to discovering a country.

The preservation of culture and eco-tourism in the Mara and in particular at the Mara Sustainability Center will help in the conservation and preservation of cultural and artistic heritage, local prosperity for non-traditional tourist destinations and the establishment of links between different cultures.

Even if Maasai Mara is a renown wonder of the world if the community members and all stakeholders don't hold into account sticking to traditions, there have been signs of cultural degradation. A question has to be raised about whether the traditional protection will be enough for the environment and sacred forests and other sites in the future. If the traditional values are not passed to the next generation, a big amount of cultural heritage shall disappear along with the shrines. In order to establish any ecotourism ventures, profound studies about the ways of usage and protection of the sacred sites should be conducted.

Another assessment question was, whether ecotourism could help to prevent the degradation of indigenous forests. There are evidences of the risks that come with tourism business, like cultural degradation and an increase in the common price level in the area. The global tourist flows are varying in time. However, the trend of people yearning for new experiences will probably never change. The communities in the Maasai Mara should not consider adapting ecotourism as their main revenue source, but it could bring the extra direct benefits like wages and employment in the communities as well as cause indirect money circulation in the region. This could lead to the establishment of other alternative enterprises.

The benefits of ecotourism center even more important in means of sustainability would be the raising of awareness. The ideal situation would be, that ecotourism brought along a strong environmental education factor, which would reach the Maasai communities in large and create a common feeling about the various resources available and about the importance of sustainable agro- forestry practices. In a phase, like the one that Maasai is going through, when the bond is week or cut between the generations in means of passing traditional knowledge, some new efforts are needed to revive this capacity. The employment opportunities for young people would keep them in their native areas.

A SWOT –analysis is done here in order to summarize the primary factors affecting the potential for sustainable ecotourism development in the Maasai Mara.

STRENGTHS	WEAKNESSES
● Unique natural features ● Welcoming Maasai culture ● Active community-based organizations ● Active non-governmental organizations ● Good Location ● Locals´ positive attitude towards ecotourism ● The timing for the need of extra household income correlates with the tourist favoring season ● The different level policies encourage ecotourism development ● Gazetted Management plans in the Maasai Mara and the greater ecosystem.	● The infrastructure needs upgrading (This resonates with the establishment of the Mara Sustainability Center) ● The security of travelers is difficult to guarantee ● Lack of enough and well trained Maasai women for beadwork (The Emarti Women Centre is built to address this) ● The different level stakeholders working for conservation and development lack collaboration ● Lack of government capacity to spread the knowledge about new policies and their possibilities and responsibilities ● The marketing for a special target group (hard Eco tourists) has a cost-benefit-ratio of low productivity

OPPORTUNITIES	THREATS
• The Maasai Mara Management Plan and Greater Mara Ecosystem Plan makes this a possibility. • The Plans forms base for new empowerment possibilities in communities • Community-based ecotourism can increase the formation of other community-based enterprises and support enterprise development in the region in general • Ecotourism could raise awareness about various agroforestry values among the communities • Opportunity for Kenya to diversify its tourism product supply	• The "fragmentation" of organizational responsibility without co-ordination and collaborative mechanisms in forest and land management • Too rapid change of forest usage and destruction of the Mau complex. • Lack of patience in communities during ecotourism development projects • Conflicting values among the community members (Christianity vs. traditional believes) • Inadequacy of traditional protection of sacred sites on trust land

From the assessment study, the respondents alluded to the fact that school and community public library is an important element that is evidently showing positive results from the already established ones. Most of them mentioned that it is important update hardware and software, enabling to the Wi-Fi connection. The assessment also noted that increasing study areas for groups and creating quiet areas for students and adults to work separately. Most of the respondent noted that the study room is small so some learners can't join the program. And provision of a quiet computer room for the librarian. They also need to be a define space for teens (young learners) so that the other learners can use the library undisturbed.

Community Members had many positive things to say about the Library. The most frequently mentioned assets or strengths of the Library were:

- Staff and the level of service provided were mentioned as strengths
    - Friendly, strong, superb, helpful, forward-looking, open-minded, supportive
- Good Children's programs
    - After school program for students
- The collection of books and other materials
    - Best sellers

- Children's books
- Textbooks – CBC rated books

- English Conversation classes
- Technology
  - One-on-one computer tutoring.

The respondents were optimistic that Outreach programs at the Mara Sustainability Centre (e.g. concerts, films, lectures), hours, study spaces, location, gathering place will be a game changer. The respondents also recommended the following as an ideal atmosphere for a community public library:

- Collaboration with schools, *(Between Aitong Primary and Olkimitare – There exist a good collaboration)*, cultural groups and *economic empowerment* was a theme that was common to all five gatherings.
- An environment welcoming of all cultures. (All gatherings)
  - Creating and collaboration space
  - Easily reconfigured for different size groups
  - Library as gathering space for learners
  - Physical space reflects the community

- Bigger space and/or reconfiguration of space to accommodate the needs of multiple user groups. (All gatherings)
  - Information desk
  - Increased study & community rooms
  - Drive through book return
  - Comfortable outdoor space

- Increased availability of technology, including e-Books.
  - Increased integration of technology: remain 'ahead of the curve'
  - 'Ubiquitous access'
  - Access to tablets and other devices
- Dedicated recreation space.
  - More fun gathering place
  - Play area with oversight

Participants in the focus groups, interviews and community meetings contributed a broad range of

ideas about improving the library and moving it closer to the ideal described above. Recommendation themes were:

- 'Improve Library PR' was a theme common to all groups.
    - Increased use of Facebook, Twitter, and other social media
    - Branding
    - Get our story out there/Engage in library advocacy
    - Send program information to key stakeholders in the area
- Increase accessibility/ease of use with signs, a directory, and an orientation. (4 of 5 gatherings)
    - "Map quest for Books" location finder
    - Brochure for orienting new people to the library
    - Announcements on video screen of programs, etc.
    - Easier sign-up for programs (integrate sign up time into program itself so that people aren't waiting around in a line but are interacting in a meaningful way while they are being 'processed')
    - Translation for non-locals
        - Materials
        - Interpretation during programs
        - Host a weekly "How to use your library" tutorial in English and Local dialect.
- Increase and enhance technology at the Library.
    - Increase computers, printers to attract, engage young people
    - Basic computer skills classes
- More programs for children, including games and other fun activities.
    - Library is the place for a play date, meet other children
    - Foster interaction among children of similar ages
    - More cross-generational programs, sharing with children, youth
- Expand/reconfigure space for Library patrons. (3 of 5 gatherings)
    - Quiet space
    - Loud/collaborative space
    - Kids space
- Increase outreach and information within the community. (3 of 5 gatherings)
    - Share 'evolving state of the library' with the broader community ("Liaise with the Librarian")
    - Staff outreach to community groups; speakers from library
    - Signage at events in the community

- Increase funding (resources - Incentives) and staff for the

Library.

- Classes in local dialect - Maasai.
- Better/faster Wi-Fi

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